

Nitin Gadkari launches indigenous software for small enterprises

India's transport minister recently launched the Calculate Business Desktop for small and medium enterprises. Based on the Linux platform, this indigenous software is in keeping with the Indian government's vision to 'Make in India' and export to the world.

Transport minister Nitin Gadkari recently released indigenous software called Calculate Business Desktop, which is aimed at small and medium enterprises. Also known as KBD, the software will apparently enable firms to do their accounting, inventory, sales and purchase functions in an economical way.

The event was attended by Virender Singh, MP from Bhadohi; Ashwini Mahajan, co-convenor, Swadeshi Jagran Manch; Vishwas Tripathi, chairman, UNI; Naresh Sirohi, advisor, Kisan Channel; Shabir Ali, MP; and Babu Dev Apte, ex-MP, apart from many others.

Addressing the gathering at the event, the minister said that 'Make in India' and Made in India would go hand in hand in the years to come. He pointed out the significance of biotechnology and information technology for the country's future, and stressed on reducing dependence on imports, promoting exports and transforming knowledge into wealth.

KBD is built on the Linux platform in accordance with the government's new open source policy. As it is integrated with the Openlx Linux operating system, the user gets an office suite, operating system, graphics and multimedia applications, and an Internet suite of applications.

Additionally, the software allows business users to get the advantages of an inexpensive, secure, virus-free environment with a user-friendly GUI by merging Openlx Linux with Calculate business accounting software.

KBD is aimed at companies that are compelled to use pirated software as they cannot afford the high cost of proprietary software. By using KBD, the total cost of business software for a firm will drop to Rs 9999.

Addressing the audience, Gadkari said that Prime Minister Modi had often emphasised the importance of the Digital

India drive, e-governance and other technological innovations for the development of the country. While the Digital India initiative aims to make government services available to Indian citizens electronically, e-governance ensures that the services reach citizens through the electronic media. The Digital India programme also intends to connect rural areas with high-speed Internet networks.

Gadkari mentioned that lack of knowledge is the biggest problem in India, and added that 'gyan, vigyan and tantra vighyan' are significant for a nation's progress.

Sudhir Gandotra, CEO, Openlx, said, "Being an Indian company, we have always looked forward to manufacturing products in our country, which will

be exported. The vision is to create Indian products that will become renowned across the world. Creating IT products in our country will help to create infrastructure and jobs. Indian technological innovations will push us towards progress."

The 'Make in India' initiative of the government of India was introduced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on September 25, 2014, in a function at the Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi. It aims to turn India into a global manufacturing hub, and focuses on 25 sectors of the economy for job creation and skills enhancement. These include industries like automobiles, pharmaceuticals, chemicals, mining, biotechnology, IT, leather, textiles, ports, aviation, tourism and hospitality, auto components, design manufacturing, wellness, railways, electronics and renewable energy.

It is the concept of 'Make in India' that is driving initiatives like Openlx, which has been launched with the aim of helping SMEs and SOHOs in India. 



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